

THE RITE OF MARRIAGE

Joseph & Storm

September 12, 2026

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PART ONE

THE INTRODUCTORY RITES

During the Entrance Hymn, the Priest greets and welcomes the bride and groom at the altar. Then they light candles as a reminder of their baptism when they received the light of Christ and so began their respective life journeys with God.

The Greeting

When the Entrance Hymn is concluded, the Priest and the faithful, standing, sign themselves with the Sign of the Cross, while the Priest, facing the people, says:

Priest: In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.

The people reply: Amen.

Then the Priest, extending his hands, greets the people, saying:

The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ,
and the love of God,
and the communion of the Holy Spirit
be with you all.

The people reply: And with your spirit.

The Priest speaks to the couple and all present in order to prepare them for the celebration of Marriage.

The Penitential Act (Lord have mercy) is omitted. The Gloria in excelsis (Glory to God in the highest) is said.

Glory to God in the highest,
and on earth peace to people of good will.
We praise you,
we bless you,
we adore you,
we glorify you,
we give you thanks for your great glory,
Lord God, heavenly King,
O God, almighty Father.
Lord Jesus Christ, Only Begotten Son,
Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father,
you take away the sins of the world,
have mercy on us;

you take away the sins of the world,
receive our prayer;
you are seated at the right hand of the Father,
have mercy on us.
For you alone are the Holy One,
you alone are the Lord,
you alone are the Most High,
Jesus Christ,
with the Holy Spirit,
in the glory of God the Father.
Amen.

COLLECT (Opening Prayer)

The Priest, with hands joined, says:

Priest: Let us pray.

All pray in silence with the Priest for a while.

Be attentive to our prayers, O Lord,
and in your kindness
pour out your grace on these your servants, Joseph and Storm;
that, coming together before your altar,
they may be confirmed in love for one another.
Through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son,
who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.

The people reply: Amen.

PART TWO

THE LITURGY OF THE WORD

First Reading

A reading from the Book of Sirach (26:1-4, 13-16)

Blessed the husband of a good wife, twice-lengthened are his days; a worthy wife brings joy to her husband, peaceful and full is his life. A good wife is a generous gift bestowed upon him who fears the Lord; be he rich or poor, his heart is content, and a smile is ever on his face.

A gracious wife delights her husband, her thoughtfulness puts flesh on his bones; a gift from the Lord is her governed speech, and her firm virtue is of surpassing worth. Choicest of blessings is a modest wife, priceless her chaste soul. A holy and decent woman adds grace upon grace; indeed, no price is worthy of her temperate soul. Like the sun rising in the Lord's heavens, the beauty of a virtuous wife is the radiance of her home.

The word of the Lord.

All: Thanks be to God.

Responsorial Psalm — Psalm 145

R. (9a) How good is the Lord to all.

The Lord is kind and full of compassion, slow to anger, abounding in mercy. How good is the Lord to all, compassionate to all his creatures. **R.**

All your works shall thank you, O Lord, and all your faithful ones bless you. The eyes of all look to you and you give them their food in due season. **R.**

The Lord is righteous in all his ways and holy in all his deeds. The Lord is close to all who call him, who call on him in truth. **R.**

Second Reading

A reading from the first Letter of St. Paul to the Corinthians (12:31–13:8a)

But earnestly desire the best gifts. Moreover, I show a most excellent way to you.

If I speak with the languages of men and of angels, but don't have love, I have become sounding brass, or a clanging cymbal. If I have the gift of prophecy, and know all mysteries and all knowledge; and if I have all faith, so as to remove mountains, but don't have love, I am nothing. If I bestow all my goods to feed the poor, and if I give my body to be burned, but don't have love, it profits me nothing.

Love is patient and is kind; love doesn't envy. Love doesn't brag, is not proud, doesn't behave itself inappropriately, doesn't seek its own way, is not provoked, takes no account of evil; doesn't rejoice in unrighteousness, but rejoices with the truth; bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things.

Love never fails.

The word of the Lord.

All: Thanks be to God.

Gospel Acclamation

All stand as the Gospel Acclamation is sung

Alleluia, alleluia!
God is love;
let us love one another
as God has loved us.
Alleluia

Gospel

Priest: The Lord be with you.

All: And with your spirit.

Priest: A reading from the holy Gospel according to John (17:20-26)

All: Glory to you, O Lord.

Priest: Jesus raised his eyes to heaven and prayed:

“Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who will believe in me through their word, that they may all be one; even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me.

The glory which you have given me, I have given to them, that they may be one, even as we are one, I in them, and you in me, that they may be perfected into one, that the world may know that you sent me and loved them, even as you loved me.

Father, I desire that they also whom you have given me be with me where I am, that they may see my glory which you have given me, for you loved me before the foundation of the world.

Righteous Father, the world hasn't known you, but I knew you; and these knew that you sent me. I made known to them your name, and will make it known; that the love with which you loved me may be in them, and I in them.”

The Gospel of the Lord.

All: Praise to You, Lord Jesus Christ.

PART THREE

THE RITE OF MARRIAGE

All stand, including the bride and bridegroom, whom the priest now addresses in the following or similar words.

Address

Dear children of God, you have come today to pledge your love before God and before the Church here present today in the person of the priest, your families and friends.

In becoming husband and wife you give yourselves to each other for life. You promise to be true and faithful, to support and cherish each other until death, so that your years together will be the living out in love of the pledge you now make. May your love for each other reflect the enduring love of Christ for his Church.

As you face the future together, keep in mind that the sacrament of marriage unites you with Christ, and brings you, through the years, the grace and blessing of God our Father. Marriage is from God: he alone can give you the happiness which goes beyond human expectation, and which grows deeper through the difficulties and struggles of life.

Put your trust in God as you set out together in life. Make your home a centre of Christian family life. (In this you will bequeath to your children a heritage more lasting than temporal wealth.)

The Christian home makes Christ and his Church present in the world of everyday things. May all who enter your home find there the presence of the Lord: for he has said: "Where two or three are gathered in my name, there am I in the midst of them."

Now as you are about to exchange your marriage vows, the Church wishes to be assured that you appreciate the meaning of what you do, and so I ask you:

Have you come here of your own free will and choice and without compulsion to marry each other?

Joseph and Storm: We have.

Will you love and honour each other in marriage all the days of your life?

Joseph and Storm: We will.

Are you willing to accept with love the children God may send you, and bring them up in accordance with the law of Christ and his Church?

Joseph and Storm: We are.

Declaration of Consent

I invite you to declare before God and his Church your consent to become husband and wife.

They join hands. The Priest then asks the bridegroom:

Joseph, do you take Storm, as your wife
for better, for worse,
for richer, for poorer,
in sickness and in health,
all the days of your life?

Groom: I do.

The Priest then asks the bride:

Storm, do you take Joseph, as your husband
for better, for worse,
for richer, for poorer,
in sickness and in health,
all the days of your life?

Storm: I do.

When the bride and bridegroom have given their consent, the Priest says:

What God joins together man must not separate.

May the Lord confirm the consent you have given and enrich you with his blessing.

Blessing of Rings

The Priest says the following prayer of blessing

Almighty God, bless † these rings, symbols of faithfulness and unbroken love. May Joseph and Storm always be true to each other, may they be one in heart and mind, may they be united in love forever.

Through Christ our Lord.

All reply: Amen.

The bridegroom places the bride's ring on her finger. He says:

Storm, wear this ring as a sign of our faithful love. In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.

The bride places a ring on the bridegroom's finger. She says:

Joseph, wear this ring as a sign of our faithful love. In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.

The bridegroom may give gold and silver to the bride saying:

I give you this gold and silver, tokens of all I possess.

Prayer of the Newly Married Couple

We thank you, Lord, and we praise you
for bringing us to this happy day.
You have given us to each other.
Now, together, we give ourselves to you.
We ask you, Lord:
make us one in your love;
keep us one in your peace.
Protect our marriage.
Bless our home.
Make us gentle. Keep us faithful.
And when life is over unite us again
where parting is no more
in the kingdom of your love.
There we will praise you in the happiness and peace
of our eternal home. Amen.

The bride and groom light one candle representing their union in the sacrament of marriage and their desire to keep the flame of faith alive in their hearts.

The Universal Prayer (Prayer of the Faithful)

1. For Joseph and Storm, that the Lord who has brought them to this happy day will keep them forever in fidelity and love. Lord, hear us. **R/. Lord, graciously hear us.**
2. For the families of Joseph and Storm, for their friends and all who have helped them to become husband and wife. Lord, hear us... **R/.**
3. For our community and families, who welcome Christ into their lives; that they learn to receive him in the poor and suffering people of this world. Lord hear us... **R/.**
4. For all who are victims of injustice, and for those deprived of love and affection. Lord hear us... **R/.**
5. For married couples everywhere, that their lives will be an example to the world of unity, fidelity and love. Lord hear us... **R/.**
6. For those who are mourning while we are rejoicing, that in their suffering and loneliness they may experience the strength of God's support. Lord hear us... **R/.**
7. For the faithful departed and especially for those whom we, ourselves, have loved, that God will one day unite us again in the joys of our eternal home. Lord hear us... **R/.**

PART FOUR

LITURGY OF THE EUCHARIST

The bride and bridegroom may bring the bread and wine to the altar. The preparation of the gifts continues in the usual way. While the Offertory Chant or a hymn is sung, the Priest prays the following:

Blessed are you, Lord God of all creation, for through your goodness we have received the bread we offer you: fruit of the earth and work of human hands, it will become for us the bread of life.

Then he places the paten with the bread on the corporal. If, however, the Offertory Chant is not sung, the Priest may speak these words aloud; at the end, the people may acclaim:

Blessed be God for ever.

The Priest then takes the chalice and holds it slightly raised above the altar with both hands, saying in a low voice:

Blessed are you, Lord God of all creation, for through your goodness we have received the wine we offer you: fruit of the vine and work of human hands, it will become our spiritual drink.

Then he places the chalice on the corporal. If, however, the Offertory Chant is not sung, the Priest may speak these words aloud; at the end, the people may acclaim:

Blessed be God for ever.

After this, the Priest, bowing profoundly, says quietly:

With humble spirit and contrite heart may we be accepted by you, O Lord, and may our sacrifice in your sight this day be pleasing to you, Lord God.

After the gifts have been prepared, the Priest, standing at the side of the altar, washes his hands, saying quietly:

Wash me, O Lord, from my iniquity and cleanse me from my sin.

The Priest then invites the people to rise, saying:

Pray, brothers and sisters, that my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable to God, the Almighty Father.

The people reply: May the Lord accept the sacrifice at your hands for the praise and glory of His name, for our good, and the good of all His holy Church.

Prayer Over the Offerings

Receive in your kindness, Lord, the offerings we bring in gladness before you, and in your fatherly love watch over those you have joined in a sacramental covenant.

Through Christ our Lord.

The people reply: Amen.

The Eucharistic Prayer

Preface: The great Sacrament of Matrimony.

V. The Lord be with you. **R. And with your spirit.**

V. Lift up your hearts. **R. We lift them up to the Lord.**

V. Let us give thanks to the Lord our God. **R. It is right and just.**

It is truly right and just, our duty and our salvation, always and everywhere to give you thanks, Lord, holy Father, almighty and eternal God, through Christ our Lord.

For in him you have made a new covenant with your people, so that, as you have redeemed man and woman by the mystery of Christ's Death and Resurrection, so in Christ you might make them partakers of divine nature and joint heirs with him of heavenly glory.

In the union of husband and wife you give a sign of Christ's loving gift of grace, so that the Sacrament we celebrate might draw us back more deeply into the wondrous design of your love.

And so, with the Angels and all the Saints, we praise you, and without end we acclaim:

All: Holy, Holy, Holy Lord God of hosts. Heaven and earth are full of your glory. Hosanna in the highest. Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest.

The people kneel. The Priest, with hands extended, says:

You are indeed Holy, O Lord, the fount of all holiness. Make holy, therefore, these gifts, we pray, by sending down your Spirit upon them like the dewfall, so that they may become for us the Body † and Blood of our Lord Jesus Christ.

At the time he was betrayed and entered willingly into his Passion, he took bread and, giving thanks, broke it, and gave it to his disciples, saying:

Take this, all of you, and eat of it, for this is my Body, which will be given up for you.

He shows the consecrated host to the people, places it again on the paten, and genuflects in adoration. After this, he continues:

In a similar way, when supper was ended, he took the chalice and, once more giving thanks, he gave it to his disciples, saying:

Take this, all of you, and drink from it, for this is the chalice of my Blood, the Blood of the new and eternal covenant, which will be poured out for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. Do this in memory of me.

He shows the chalice to the people, places it on the corporal, and genuflects in adoration. Then he says:

The mystery of faith.

And the people continue, acclaiming: We proclaim your Death, O Lord, and profess your Resurrection until you come again.

Then the Priest, with hands extended, says:

Therefore, as we celebrate the memorial of his Death and Resurrection, we offer you, Lord, the Bread of life and the Chalice of salvation, giving thanks that you have held us worthy to be in your presence and minister to you.

Humbly we pray that, partaking of the Body and Blood of Christ, we may be gathered into one by the Holy Spirit.

Remember, Lord, your Church, spread throughout the world, and bring her to the fullness of charity, together with Francis our Pope and Donal our Bishop and all the clergy.

Be mindful also, Lord, of Joseph and Storm, whom you have brought to their wedding day, so that by your grace they may abide in mutual love and in peace.

Remember also our brothers and sisters who have fallen asleep in the hope of the resurrection, and all who have died in your mercy: welcome them into the light of your face.

Have mercy on us all, we pray, that with the Blessed Virgin Mary, Mother of God, with the blessed Apostles, and all the Saints who have pleased you throughout the ages, we may merit to be coheirs to eternal life, and may praise and glorify you

He joins his hands.

through your Son, Jesus Christ.

He takes the chalice and the paten with the host and, raising both, he says:

Through him, and with him, and in him, O God, almighty Father, in the unity of the Holy Spirit, all glory and honor is yours, for ever and ever.

The people acclaim: Amen.

PART FIVE

THE COMMUNION RITE

The Priest introduces the Lord's Prayer

At the Savior's command and formed by divine teaching, we dare to say:

Our Father, who art in heaven,
hallowed be thy name;
thy kingdom come,
thy will be done
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our trespasses,
as we forgive those who trespass against us;
and lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.

The Nuptial Blessing

After the Our Father, the prayer Deliver us is omitted. The Priest, standing and facing the bride and bridegroom, invokes upon them God's blessing. The bride and bridegroom remain at their place and kneel.

The Priest, with hands joined, calls upon those present to pray, saying:

Let us humbly invoke by our prayers, dear brothers and sisters, God's blessing upon this bride and groom, that in his kindness he may favor with his help those on whom he has bestowed the Sacrament of Matrimony.

All pray in silence for a while. Then the Priest, with hands extended over the bride and bridegroom, continues:

Holy Father, maker of the whole world, who created man and woman in your own image and willed that their union be crowned with your blessing, we humbly beseech you for these your servants, who are joined today in the Sacrament of Matrimony.

May your abundant blessing, Lord, come down upon this bride, Storm, and upon Joseph, her companion for life, and may the power of your Holy Spirit set their hearts aflame from on high, so that, living out together the gift of Matrimony, they may (adorn their family with children and) enrich the Church. In happiness may they praise you, O Lord, in sorrow may they seek you out; may they have the joy of your presence to assist them in their toil, and know that you are near to comfort them in their need; let them pray to you in the holy assembly and bear witness to you in the world, and after a happy

old age, together with the circle of friends that surrounds them, may they come to the Kingdom of Heaven.

Through Christ our Lord.

All. Amen.

The prayer Lord Jesus Christ is omitted and The peace of the Lord is said immediately.

The peace of the Lord be with you always.

The people reply: And with your spirit.

Let us offer each other the sign of peace.

Then the bride and groom and all present offer one another a sign, in keeping with local customs, that expresses peace, communion and charity.

Then he takes the host, breaks it over the paten, and places a small piece in the chalice, saying quietly:

May this mingling of the Body and Blood of our Lord Jesus Christ bring eternal life to us who receive it.

Meanwhile the following is sung or said:

Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the world,
have mercy on us.

Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the world,
have mercy on us.

Lamb of God, you take away the sins of the world,
grant us peace.

Then the Priest, with hands joined, says quietly:

Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God, who, by the will of the Father and the work of the Holy Spirit, through your Death gave life to the world, free me by this, your most holy Body and Blood, from all my sins and from every evil; keep me always faithful to your commandments, and never let me be parted from you.

The Priest genuflects, takes the host and, holding it slightly raised above the paten or above the chalice, while facing the people, says aloud:

Behold the Lamb of God, behold him who takes away the sins of the world. Blessed are those called to the supper of the Lamb.

And together with the people he adds once:

Lord, I am not worthy that you should enter under my roof, but only say the word and my soul shall be healed.

The Priest, facing the altar, says quietly:

May the Body of Christ keep me safe for eternal life.

And he reverently consumes the Body of Christ. Then he takes the chalice and says quietly:

May the Blood of Christ keep me safe for eternal life.

And he reverently consumes the Blood of Christ. The Communion now follows.

Anyone not presently disposed to receive the Eucharist today for any reason is warmly invited to receive a blessing from the priest. They can indicate that this is their intention by having their arms folded before the chest, and slightly bowing the head. The priest will be happy to offer a personal prayer of blessing for them. Thank you for your respect at this most sacred moment.

Prayer After Communion

Let us pray.

All pray silently for a while. Then the Priest says the Prayer after Communion:

Having been made partakers at your table, we pray, O Lord, that Joseph and Storm who are united by the Sacrament of Marriage may always hold fast to you and proclaim your name to the world.

Through Christ our Lord.

The people reply: Amen.

PART SIX

THE CONCLUDING RITES

Solemn Blessing at the End of Mass

The Priest, facing the people and extending his hands, says:

The Lord be with you.

The people reply: And with your spirit.

The Priest, with hands extended over the bride and bridegroom, says:

May God the eternal Father keep you of one heart in love for one another, that the peace of Christ may dwell in you and abide always in your home.

The people reply: Amen.

May you be blessed in your children, have solace in your friends and enjoy true peace with everyone.

The people reply: Amen.

May you be witnesses in the world to God's charity, so that the afflicted and needy who have known your kindness may one day receive you thankfully into the eternal dwelling of God.

The people reply: Amen.

And he blesses all the people, adding:

And may almighty God bless all of you, who are gathered here, the Father, and the Son, † and the Holy Spirit.

The people reply: Amen.

Dismissal

Then the Priest says:

Go in peace, glorifying the Lord by your life.

The people reply: Thanks be to God.

The Register may now be signed at some suitable place in or near the sanctuary.